# Excellent Meatballs

Beef & pork | Oven

## Before you start

Equipment: sauté pan and baking sheet. Oven: 350°F. Bake: about 15 minutes after browning. Plan ahead: cool the cooked onion mixture completely before mixing with meat.

## Ingredients

[ ] Extra-virgin olive oil

[ ] 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch

[ ] Salt

[ ] 2 garlic cloves, chopped

[ ] Pinch crushed red pepper

[ ] 1/2 lb ground beef

[ ] 1/2 lb ground veal

[ ] 1/2 lb ground pork

[ ] 2 large eggs

[ ] 1 cup grated Parmigiano

[ ] 1/4 cup finely chopped Italian parsley

[ ] 1 cup breadcrumbs

[ ] 1/2 cup water

[ ] Marinara sauce, for serving

# Method

## 1. Cook and cool the aromatics

**1.** Coat a large sauté pan with extra-virgin olive oil. Add 1 large onion, diced about 1/4 inch, and salt. Cook over medium-high heat **5-7 minutes**, until very soft but not browned.

**2.** Add 2 chopped garlic cloves and a pinch of crushed red pepper. Cook **1-2 minutes**, then let the mixture cool completely.

## 2. Mix and shape

**1.** Combine **1/2 lb** ground beef, **1/2 lb** ground veal, **1/2 lb** ground pork, 2 large eggs, **1 cup** grated Parmigiano, **1/4 cup** finely chopped Italian parsley, and **1 cup** breadcrumbs.

**2.** Mix in the cooled onion mixture and season generously with salt. Add **1/2 cup** water and mix thoroughly; the mixture should be quite moist.

**3.** Cook a small tester patty and adjust seasoning if needed.

**4.** Heat the oven to **350°F**. Shape meatballs slightly larger than golf balls.

## 3. Brown and bake

**1.** Brown the meatballs on all sides in olive oil over medium-high heat, working in batches.

**2.** Transfer to a baking sheet and bake about **15 minutes**, until cooked through. Serve with marinara.

## Notes and variations

Make-ahead option from the saved recipe: cool the cooked meatballs and freeze for later.

## Source

Original recipe:
https://www.foodnetwork.com/recipes/anne-burrell/excellent-meatballs-recipe-1943292

Archived for personal use; directions have been condensed/paraphrased from the linked source.